

Start talking

Cooing and speaking “parentese” to your baby from birth is vital for her speech development. Research shows that the long, clear sounds parents speak to their newborn is a key part of the language process. So don’t feel embarrassed about using singsong speech and exaggerated facial expressions to produce long vowels and clear changes in tone as you speak to her.

Begin your baby journal

You will notice something different about your baby each day, so write it down in a journal and stick in photos you love. Though it may seem very early to start a journal, adding notes and photos week by week—or month by month—quickly helps to build her history. You won’t forget



what she is like now if you have prompts to jog your memory later on, and you will be able to treasure her first year. If you have twins, take photos of them together and separately; they’ll want to see photos of their sibling, but also follow their own story.